KALE REALTY

NEW AGENTS GET ZERO REPEAT BUSINESS.

That's not a skill gap. It's math.

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A 16-YEAR AGENT GETS HALF THEIR BUSINESS FROM REPEAT CLIENTS. A BRAND-NEW AGENT GETS NONE OF IT.

NAR's own 2026 numbers. Not a talent gap, a tenure gap.

03 / 05

REPEAT BUSINESS ISN'T EARNED BY BEING GOOD. IT'S EARNED BY HAVING BEEN IN BUSINESS LONG ENOUGH.

NAR's 2026 Member Profile found repeat clients make up a median 49 percent of business for agents with 16 or more years in the field, and referrals make up another 32 percent. For agents with two years or less, both numbers are zero. That is not because new agents are worse at the job. They have not been licensed long enough to have past clients to call on yet.

IF YOU'RE IN YOUR FIRST TWO YEARS, OR WEIGHING WHERE A NEW AGENT SHOULD START:

1 **Don't budget for repeat business you don't have yet.**
A new agent's plan has to run on

2 **fresh leads, not referrals, because the referral pipeline takes years to build.**

3 **Ask a brokerage exactly how a brand-new agent gets leads.**
A split built around a

4 **15-year veteran's referral book does nothing for someone starting at zero.**

5 **Track your own repeat and referral percentage every year.**
Watching it rise off zero is

6 **the real sign the business is compounding, not just surviving.**

7 **Weight training and lead support higher than commission split in year one.**
The split

8 **matters more once you have the repeat business to actually keep.**

THE TAKEAWAY

IF YOU'RE CHOOSING WHERE TO HANG YOUR LICENSE THIS YEAR, ASK WHAT THEY DO FOR AN AGENT WITH ZERO REPEAT BUSINESS YET.

Most splits are built for agents who already have it.

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